Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 07/07/2025	**Entry:** 2
Description	There was a security event on 07/07/2026 beginning at 1:11 p,m. When an employee received an email containing a file attachment. At 1:13 the employee successfully downloaded and opened the file. At 1:15 multiple unauthorized executable files are created on the employee's computer. At 1:20 an intrusion detection system detects the executable files and sends out an alert to the SOC.
Tool(s) used	An IDS and VirusTotal were used to detect and verify the malware
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **A malicious attacker who sent the email** • **An email containing malware was opened by an employee** • **07/07/2026 at 1:11 p.m.** • **At the employee's computer at the financial services company** • **It happened because an email containing malware was sent by a malicious attacker**
Additional notes	Potentially need to review cybersecurity procedures in regards to phishing emails with employees.

Date:	**Entry:**

Record the date of the journal entry.	Record the journal entry number.
Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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- **Who** caused the incident?
- **What** happened?
- **When** did the incident occur?
- **Where** did the incident happen?
- **Why** did the incident happen?

Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.